



HINA NAGARAJAN
58, MD & CEO,
DIAGEO INDIA

SPIRITS GUIDE

After taking charge at Diageo India in mid-2021, Hina Nagarajan brought in a new growth strategy that has catapulted the firm's business over the past year. Its listed entity, United Spirits, reported 10.1 per cent growth in net sales to ₹10,611 crore in FY23, while its net profit climbed 24 per cent to ₹1,052 crore. With the company becoming net debt free, its market capitalisation has surged 25 per cent to ₹75,770 crore. Nagarajan now plans to sharpen the portfolio in line with the changing consumer landscape. "Within the organisation, we will continue to focus on driving agility, digital transformation and a culture of high performance to help deliver on our commitments," she says. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA



ISHA AMBANI
32, DIRECTOR, RIL, RELIANCE RETAIL & RELIANCE JIO INFOCOMM

Retail Maven

WITH REVENUE OF ₹2.6 lakh crore, Reliance Industries Ltd's retail business, Reliance Retail, is a leader in the space by some distance. Interestingly, its revenue continues to grow on a large base—in fact, it grew by 30 per cent over the last fiscal. And at the helm is Isha Ambani,

its Director, who has given the business a big push from the time she came aboard in 2014.

From moving into new formats to bringing in world-class brands, and making strategic acquisitions to raising huge amounts of funding, Ambani, who holds an MBA

from Stanford University, is hungry for more growth. And the opening of the Jio World Plaza, the country's largest luxury mall, is a clear indication of the company's growth plans under the watchful eye of Ambani, who recently joined RIL's board as Director. Driven by the inherent belief that India provides a lot of room to grow, Reliance Retail has added 3,000 stores, or an additional 20 million sq. ft in FY23, bringing the total store count to above 18,000.

And with the scale that the Reliance group brings to any business it steps into, the disruption in the retail sector is real, and at several levels. Take the case of the traditional *kirana* stores, and how Reliance Retail is leveraging technology to track and understand consumer behaviour better. This has enabled the company to help shopkeepers optimise their shelf space, which in turn is leading to increased sales.

Besides, having created its own portfolio of brands across categories, the company has clearly outlined its intention of cornering a large chunk of the fast-moving consumer goods pie. That opens up an altogether new opportunity, and another royal battle for a share of the consumer's wallet. With its scale and ability to invest, it's not hard to understand why Ambani is so confident about the future. **BT**

— BY KRISHNA GOPALAN